Pet Cat Breeds of the World

A comprehensive reference guide to popular cat breeds across every continent

This document provides an overview of well-known pet cat breeds organized by region of origin. Each breed entry includes origin, size classification, typical lifespan, and temperament description.

Europe

British Shorthair

Origin: United Kingdom | **Size:** Medium-Large | **Lifespan:** 12-20 years

Easygoing, calm, and affectionate. One of the oldest English cat breeds, recognized for their dense plush coat and round features.

Scottish Fold

Origin: Scotland | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 11-14 years

Sweet-tempered, adaptable, and playful. Distinguished by unique folded ears that give them an owl-like appearance.

Norwegian Forest Cat

Origin: Norway | **Size:** Large | **Lifespan:** 14-16 years

Gentle, friendly, and intelligent. A robust breed with a thick double coat adapted to cold Scandinavian climates.

Russian Blue

Origin: Russia | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 15-20 years

Quiet, gentle, and loyal. Known for their striking silver-blue coat and vivid green eyes.

Chartreux

Origin: France | **Size:** Medium-Large | **Lifespan:** 12-15 years

Quiet, observant, and affectionate. A rare French breed with a woolly blue-gray coat and copper-colored eyes.

Asia

Siamese

Origin: Thailand | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 15-20 years

Social, vocal, and intelligent. One of the most recognizable breeds with striking blue almond-shaped eyes and color-point coat.

Persian

Origin: Iran (Persia) | **Size:** Medium-Large | **Lifespan:** 12-17 years

Calm, gentle, and sweet. Famous for their long, luxurious coat and flat face. One of the most popular breeds worldwide.

Burmese

Origin: Myanmar (Burma) | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 16-18 years

Affectionate, playful, and people-oriented. A social breed that forms strong bonds with their owners.

Japanese Bobtail

Origin: Japan | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 9-15 years

Active, intelligent, and talkative. Recognized by their short pom-pom-like tail, considered a symbol of good luck in Japan.

Birman

Origin: Myanmar | **Size:** Medium-Large | **Lifespan:** 12-16 years

Gentle, affectionate, and social. A striking breed with deep blue eyes and white-gloved paws, associated with Burmese temple legends.

Korat

Origin: Thailand | **Size:** Small-Medium | **Lifespan:** 15-20 years

Intelligent, playful, and loyal. An ancient breed with a silver-tipped blue coat, considered a symbol of prosperity in Thailand.

Americas

Maine Coon

Origin: United States | **Size:** Large | **Lifespan:** 12-15 years

Friendly, intelligent, and gentle. One of the largest domestic cat breeds, native to Maine with a bushy tail and tufted ears.

Ragdoll

Origin: United States | **Size:** Large | **Lifespan:** 12-17 years

Docile, calm, and affectionate. Known for going limp when picked up — hence the name. Striking blue eyes and semi-long coat.

American Shorthair

Origin: United States | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 15-20 years

Adaptable, easygoing, and good-natured. A versatile breed descended from cats that arrived with early European settlers.

Bengal

Origin: United States | **Size:** Medium-Large | **Lifespan:** 12-16 years

Energetic, playful, and confident. A hybrid breed with a wild, leopard-like spotted or marbled coat pattern.

Savannah

Origin: United States | **Size:** Large | **Lifespan:** 12-20 years

Adventurous, loyal, and energetic. A cross between a domestic cat and the African Serval, known for their tall, lean build.

Africa & Middle East

Abyssinian

Origin: Ethiopia (Abyssinia) | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 9-15 years

Active, playful, and curious. One of the oldest known breeds with a distinctive ticked tabby coat resembling a wild cat.

Egyptian Mau

Origin: Egypt | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 12-15 years

Active, loyal, and intelligent. The only naturally spotted domestic cat breed, revered in ancient Egyptian culture.

Somali

Origin: East Africa | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 11-16 years

Playful, social, and curious. Often called the "long-haired Abyssinian" with a bushy tail and vibrant ticked coat.

Oceania

Australian Mist

Origin: Australia | **Size:** Medium | **Lifespan:** 15-18 years

Friendly, gentle, and tolerant. The only cat breed developed in Australia, known for their spotted or marbled coat with a misty appearance.